Sheaf Guide

Sheaf reads, marks up, edits, converts and signs PDFs on your computer. Nothing you open leaves it. This guide walks through what you will use most. Help ▸ Keyboard Shortcuts lists every key.

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1. Home and the Tools page

- **Open a PDF**: File ▸ Open (Ctrl+O, ⌘O on a Mac), drag a file onto the window, or pick one from **Recent files** on Home. Pin the ones you come back to; the search box filters the list.
- **Tools**: every tool is on the Tools page, by group: Organize, Optimize, Convert to PDF, Convert from PDF, Edit, Security. Click a tool, add its files, choose the options, then press the button at the bottom. The result opens in a tab, or in its folder for files Sheaf does not read.
- **Favourites**: the star on a tool keeps it at the top. Open Tool in the menu bar reaches every tool from anywhere, and Settings ▸ Shortcuts can give each one its own keys.
- **History**: Home ▸ History lists what each tool made, with its files, so you can find a result again or run the same settings once more.

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2. Reading

- **Move around**: scroll, Page Down and Page Up, or Space. Home and End go to the first and last page. Type a page number in the page box to jump there.
- **Zoom**: Ctrl+plus and Ctrl+minus, Ctrl+wheel, or a pinch. The zoom menu fits the page or its width, or shows it at actual size.
- **Layouts**: View ▸ Page Layout shows single pages, two pages side by side, a continuous column or pages across. **Split view** shows two places of one document, or two documents, side by side; their scrolling and zoom can follow each other.
- **Panels**: the sidebar holds the page thumbnails, the outline (bookmarks), comments, attachments and layers. Drag thumbnails to reorder pages.
- **Search**: Ctrl+F finds words in the document. Search catalog… searches several documents or a folder at once, with whole words, match case, AND / OR / NOT and words near each other.
- **Read aloud and night reading**: More ▸ Read aloud speaks from the page shown; Settings ▸ Appearance darkens the pages or shows them in sepia.

3. Marking up

Each reader tool has a letter; press it while the pages have focus.

Tool	Key	What it does
Select Text	`V`	Select and copy text
Highlight, Underline, Strikethrough	`H, U, K`	Mark the words you drag over
Note	`N`	A sticky note where you click
Pen	`P`	Draw freehand
Shapes	`R`	Rectangles, ovals, lines, arrows, clouds; measure distances and areas
Stamp	`M`	Approved, Draft and your own stamps
Eraser	`X`	Remove the marks you drag over

Comments carry your name (Settings ▸ Reading). The Comments panel lists them, sorts them by author or type, and lets you reply to them and set their status. Summarize Comments prints them beside their pages.

4. Editing

- **Edit Text and Objects (E)**: click a line of text to change it in place, in its own font when the font allows it. Drag pictures and drawings to move them, use the handles to resize, and bring them to the front or send them back.
- **Add Image (I)** and **Link (L)** place a picture or a link where you drag.
- **Pages**: in the thumbnails, rotate, delete, insert, extract or replace pages. The Organize tool works on several files at once.
- **Undo**: Ctrl+Z undoes any change until you close the document. Nothing is written to the file until you save (Ctrl+S); Save As keeps the original as it was.

5. Forms and signing

- **Fill a form**: click a field and type. Tab moves to the next field. Auto-Complete offers what you typed before.
- **Prepare Form (F)** finds the fields of a flat form, or lets you add text fields, check boxes, lists and signature fields yourself.
- **Sign (S)**: draw, type or pick an image of your signature and initials once; Sheaf keeps them, encrypted, for the next time. Click where the signature goes.

- **Digital signatures**: with a digital ID (a .p12 or .pfx file, Settings ▸ Tools) you can certify or sign a document so any change after signing shows. The Signatures panel checks the signatures a document already holds.

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6. Converting and optimizing

- **To PDF**: images, Word, PowerPoint, Excel, web pages, Markdown and e-mails. Word, PowerPoint and Excel files use LibreOffice when it is installed; Sheaf says so when it is missing.
- **From PDF**: images, Word, PowerPoint, Excel, web pages and text, and PDF/A for archives.
- **Compress PDF** makes a file smaller at the level you choose, or down to a size you give. Advanced settings choose image resolution and quality and remove what does not show.
- **OCR PDF** recognises the text of scanned pages so you can search, select and copy it. Review recognised text shows the words it is least sure of, one by one.

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7. Security

- **Protect PDF** sets a password to open the file, and permissions for printing, copying and editing. **Unlock PDF** removes a password you know.
- **Redact PDF** removes text and areas for good: what is under a redaction is deleted from the file, not covered.
- **Security policies** save the protection you use often, to apply it in one step.

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8. Doing the same thing again

- **Actions** chain several tools (for example compress, number the pages, then recognise text) and run them on many files at once.
- **Watched folder**: every PDF dropped in a folder you choose goes through an action by itself.
- **Library** keeps the documents you work with in one place and searches their text.

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9. Settings

Settings (Ctrl+comma, Sheaf ▸ Settings… on a Mac) holds the appearance and language direction, the zoom and layout new documents open with, rendering, your name, signatures and digital IDs, and keyboard shortcuts. Every key in the menus can be changed there.